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FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/13

Paper 1 Reading

May/June 2026

2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen. Do **not** use correction fluid or tape.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **16** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.



Read **Text A, *Octopuses***, in the insert and then answer **Questions 1(a)–(e)** on this question paper.

Question 1

- (a) Give **one** thing that scientists regard as the most unusual feature of an octopus, according to paragraph 1.

..... [1]

- (b) **Using your own words**, explain what the text means by:

(i) 'fans point to' (line 4) [2]

(ii) 'escape a predator' (line 6) [2]

- (c) Reread paragraph 3 ('Later ... out to sea.').

Give **two** examples that suggest octopuses might be capable of planning for the future.

-
- [2]

- (d) Reread paragraphs 4 and 5 ("None of this ... beak.').

(i) Identify **two** reasons why Dr Lanver is **not** surprised by Inky's escape.

-
- [2]

(ii) Explain the similarities researchers have observed between octopus behaviour and human behaviour.

.....

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..... [3]





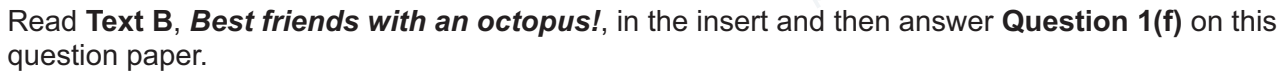
(e) Reread paragraph 6 ('Octopuses evolved ... to other octopuses.').

Using your own words, explain what human brains can do that octopuses' brains cannot do.

.....

.....

..... [3]



- Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are faint, diagonal watermarks visible across the page, which appear to say "PapaCambridge" and "papacambridge.com". The overall appearance is that of a clean, unused piece of stationery or notebook paper.



[Total: 30]

[Turn over



Read **Text C, *Marcellus***, in the insert and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** on this question paper.

Question 2

(a) **Identify a word or phrase from the text** which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

(i) Marcellus is discovered by Cameron as he is attempting to go out of the rear entrance of the aquarium.

..... [1]

(ii) Cameron is surprised when Tova appears behind him in the storeroom.

..... [1]

(iii) Terry had told Cameron that Tova's injury meant that she would not be at work for some time.

..... [1]

(iv) The newly delivered octopus is shaking in her travel container.

..... [1]

(b) **Using your own words**, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

'I came to see Marcellus,' Tova explains. 'Marcellus wanders at night, although he's never headed outside before.' She frowns, wishing Marcellus had stuck to his usual adventures: teasing the seahorses, poking around in the other tanks for a midnight snack.

'And no one else knows,' Cameron nods, understanding dawning.

(i) wanders [1]

(ii) stuck [1]

(iii) dawning [1]





- (c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests Cameron's feelings about Marcellus at this point in the story.

Use your own words in your explanation.

The octopus shifts slightly, blinking its creepy eyes. 'It's okay.' She smiles, climbing up and offering her hand. Incredibly, the creature extends one of its arms and winds it around her wrist. 'I'm going to help you down, right?'

The octopus nods.

Wait, no. It didn't. Did it? Cameron rubs his eyes.

'There you go,' the woman whispers once the thing is directly over its tank. Cold, briny water sloshes as the creature plops back in.

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..... [3]



(d) Reread paragraphs 1 and 16.

- Paragraph 1 begins ‘Cameron rubs ...’ and is about Cameron’s first encounter with Marcellus.
- Paragraph 16 begins ‘Back in his tank ...’ and is about Cameron’s attempts to make friends with Marcellus.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose **three** examples of words or phrases from **each** paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.

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[15]

[Turn over



Question 3

In your letter, you should explain:

- Write the words of the letter.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

[illegible]

[25]

If you use the following page to complete the answer to any question, the question number must be clearly shown.

[illegible]



Additional page

If you use the following page to complete the answer to any question, the question number must be clearly shown.

This image shows a full page of blank handwriting practice paper. It features multiple sets of horizontal lines. Each set consists of a solid top line, a dashed midline, and a solid bottom line, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The paper is white with light gray or blue lines. There are faint, diagonal watermarks across the page that read "PapaCambridge.com".



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